

Fungrown

To the scholars of Pliara, civilization is measured in stone, steel, and written law, achievements that place the Dwarves as the first true people of the world. To the Fungrown, those mountain halls and library stacks are merely recent additions to an ancient landscape. Living mushroom folk of small to medium stature, the Fungrown carry a deep conviction that their roots reach back to the morning of creation. They believe that when Plii first spoke life into the flora and fauna, they sprouted alongside it, making them the true firstborn of Pliara.

Outsiders rarely grant them that history, often dismissing them as simple forest wanderers or spitting the derogatory term Sporite to paint them as mere pests. Yet to walk among the Fungrown is to encounter a culture completely integrated with the natural world. They have no need for massive fortresses or grand empires. Their communities thrive in the damp shadow of ancient canopies, quiet riverbanks, and forgotten caves. While they lack the rigid structures of dwarven clans, their heritage lives on through oral traditions, shared instincts, and an enduring connection to the soil beneath their feet.

Physically, no two Fungrown look identical, but all are instantly recognizable by the prominent fungal cap topping their heads. Beneath these broad crowns are sturdy, fibrous bodies built for survival. They do not view the world through the short urgency of mortals, nor do they share common attitudes about personal property. Instead, a Fungrown moves through life with a distinct focus on purpose, whether that means tending a quiet grove for decades or venturing out into chaotic cities out of unquenchable curiosity.

Racial Traits

Ability Scores. Your Wisdom Score increases by 2

Age. The Fungrown reach maturity around 5 years old and live to be around 40 years old.

Alignment. Generally speaking, the Fungrown are a chaotic bunch with no good or evil tendencies. The Amanitacap are an exception, as they tend to lean more towards evil deeds and ideals.

Size. Fungrown sizes vary wildly between each sub-race.

Darkvision. You can see in dim light within 60 feet of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You cannot discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Sylvan. You can speak Common, though most Fungrown experience significant difficulty reading and writing Common.

Fungrown Sub-Races

Amanitacap

The Amanitacap stand out as the short, stocky, and aggressive outliers among the Fungrown race. Easily identified by their large, bright red caps studded with white spots, they possess a naturally venomous physical composition that reflects their harsh nature. Unlike their more peaceful kin, the Amanitacap harbour a deep sense of inherent superiority over all other species and subraces. They are so confident in their dominance that they willingly embrace the term Sporite, turning a label meant as an insult into a title of pride for themselves.

In combat and daily life, their deadliest trait is the poison circulating within their bodies. Amanitacap warriors routinely harvest this internal venom, draining it directly from their caps over several minutes to coat their blades before entering a fight. Immune to both poison damage and the poisoned condition themselves, they rely on these deadly coatings to enforce their will or eliminate threats. Their malicious nature and willingness to use treacherous tactics make them feared recluses who demand submission from anyone crossing their paths.

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 1.

Size. Amanitacap usually grow to around 3 feet tall and weigh around 80 pounds. Your size is Small.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 25 feet.

Poisonous. You have advantage on saving throws against poison, and you have resistance to poison damage.

Internal Poisons. Over the course of 1 minute, you can spend 1 Hit Die to coat a weapon with poison drawn directly from your cap. Upon completion, the weapon deals an additional 1d4 poison damage on a successful hit for 1 hour. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Constitution modifier per long rest.

Armillacap

The Armillacap, largest of all Fungrown, are known for their love of peace, quiet, and tranquility. Often seen in solitude or with a small group, they tend to live far longer and grow much wiser than their smaller counterparts. Travelers frequently find an Armillacap lounging in a sunny meadow or soaking under a gentle waterfall.

Standing between 5'6" and 6'0" tall, these gentle giants feature a large, nearly flat cap that doubles as a defensive shield when trouble arises. Many Fungrown colonies hire Armillacap as community guards, knowing their peaceful demeanor and calm presence help resolve dangerous situations without violence.

Ability Scores. Your Constitution Score increases by 1.

Size. Armillacap average between 5'6" and 6'0" in height and weigh around 120 pounds. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 feet.

Shield Cap. Your Armor Class increases by 1.

Fungrown Sub-Races

Creminicap

The Creminicap are the most commonly encountered of all Fungrown. These small, dome-topped creatures typically are not found in exclusive, isolated colonies. Rather, they prefer to intermingle with other species of Fungrown. More adventurous Creminicap have been known to integrate into societies in Highpeak, Essex, and other areas in Pliara. They will often find work performing difficult manual labor, making deliveries, or working as assistants to mages.

Creminicap are relatively docile in nature and extremely co-dependent. Finding a lone Creminicap is such a rarity that it would typically be an indication that the Creminicap may be lost or hurt. Even when looking to join a new colony or integrate into a new society, the Creminicap never travels alone. There is often a group of at least 3 Creminicap, although seeing two alone is not uncommon.

Creminicap love to work and enjoy feeling as though they are productive members of their society. Carpentry and shipbuilding are common hobbies of the Creminicap, while many others will delve into the magical arts. It is uncommon, although not unheard of, to wander across a Creminicap of the bardic or divine arts, however.

Standing around 3 feet tall, the Creminicap is very short, but well-built for hard work. They have the ability to force their outermost layers to shed on occasion, freeing them from any disease or poison that may have entered their bodies. Their thicker layers give them a little more cushion in absorbing damage.

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 1.

Size. Creminicap average between 2'6" and 3'6" tall and weigh around 100 lbs due to their thick composition. Your size is Small.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 25 feet.

Diplomatic. Due to their overly friendly nature, Creminicap often know just the right words for nearly any situation. When speaking with someone that you have spent at least an hour with previously, you can grant yourself advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) skill checks for 10 minutes so long as the target does not consider you hostile.

Layered Skin. Creminicap skin consists of many thin layers, each stacked upon one another. As an action, you may force the outermost layer of your skin to shed, ending either one disease or one condition afflicting you. The condition can be blinded, deafened, paralyzed, or poisoned, and you can use this ability even if one of those conditions would otherwise prevent you from doing so (such as paralyzed). You can use this ability once per long rest.

Morelcap

Morelcap are native primarily to swamps, marshes, and other areas with a lot of moisture. Easily identified by the spongy, cone-shaped cap on their heads, Morelcap are excellent swimmers that can even outswim many aquatic creatures.

Unlike the Creminicap, the Morelcap prefer to isolate themselves from the rest of the world and are often found living in colonies consisting solely of Morelcap. There have been notable instances, however, such as the Waterspore Troop in the Essex Marshlands, where Morelcap have formed complex societies with other species and races.

Although generally peaceful and compassionate in nature, a Morelcap will fight to the death to protect its home, family, and loved ones. While still smaller than the titanic Armillacap, the Morelcap stand an average of 4'6" tall; around a full foot taller than Creminicap or Amanitacap.

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 1.

Size. Morelcap average 4'6" tall and weigh around 80 lbs. Your size is Small.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 feet. You have a swim speed of 30 feet.

Torpedo. When swimming, if you move 20 feet in a straight line underwater towards a creature before hitting it with a melee attack on the same turn, the attack does an additional 2d6 bludgeoning damage. This ability may be used once per turn.

Water-Logged. You learn the Waterjet cantrip. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for this spell.